THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE UNIT TEST SET A

Chapters 2–4: **Reshaping India's Political Map, The Rise of the Marathas, The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–12 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 13–17 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 18–23 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 24–25 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 22 to 25.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Draw neat maps and diagrams wherever required.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 12 × 1 = 12

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. In this book, 'medieval' India refers to the period from: 1

(a) the 1st to the 5th centuries **(b)** the 6th to the 10th centuries
(c) the 11th to the 17th centuries **(d)** the 18th to the 20th centuries

2. The Delhi Sultanate was founded after the defeat of Prithviraj Chauhan in: 1

(a) 1757 **(b)** 1206 only **(c)** 1526 **(d)** 1192

3. The average reign of a Delhi sultan was only about: 1

(a) 9 years **(b)** 16 years **(c)** 27 years **(d)** 50 years

4. **Assertion (A):** Akbar was seen as a tolerant ruler in his later years. 1
Reason (R): He abolished jizya and promoted sulh-i-kul.
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

5. The Maratha Navy was founded in: 1

(a) 1657 **(b)** 1707 **(c)** 1674 **(d)** 1630

6. Shivaji's vision of a sovereign kingdom was called: 1

(a) Iqta **(b)** Swarajya **(c)** Sulh-i-kul **(d)** Jauhar

7. Shivaji sacked the wealthy Mughal port of: 1

(a) Calicut **(b)** Surat **(c)** Madras **(d)** Goa

8. Rajaram fled to: 1

(a) Gingee in Tamil Nadu **(b)** Agra
(c) Lahore **(d)** Pune

9. At Independence there were over ___ princely states. 1

(a) 5 **(b)** 5000 **(c)** 50 **(d)** 500

10. At the Battle of Plassey (1757), the Nawab of Bengal was: 1

(a) Siraj-ud-daulah **(b)** Mir Jafar **(c)** Tipu Sultan **(d)** Bahadur Shah

11. Railways in colonial India were designed mainly to: 1

(a) move raw materials to ports and troops quickly
(b) help artisans
(c) connect village markets
(d) promote travel for fun

12. India's share of world GDP at Independence was hardly: 1

(a) 5% **(b)** 15% **(c)** 25% **(d)** 50%

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 10–15 words each.

13. What made Babur's victory at Panipat easier? 2

14. Describe the Afzal Khan episode in two lines. 2

15. Why did Shivaji create a navy? 2

16. Name the European powers that came to India. 2

17. What was the Doctrine of Lapse? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 6 × 3 = 18

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

18. Compare Akbar's and Aurangzeb's policies on religion. 3

19. Describe three famous episodes of Shivaji's struggle with Bijapur and the Mughals. 3

20. Describe the French in India. 3

21. Describe the Portuguese in India: arrival, Goa and the cartaz system. 3

22. Why did the Mughal Empire decline after Aurangzeb? 3

OR

Describe Akbar's early rule and his later strategy of tolerance. 3

23. How did the Maratha structure change after Shivaji? 3

OR

Describe Shivaji's early life and rise. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

24. Describe the foundation of Maratha power and Shivaji's rise from childhood to coronation. 5

OR

Trace Maratha history after Shivaji: Sambhaji, Rajaram, Tarabai and the Peshwas. 5

25. Describe changes in governance and education under colonial rule. 5

OR

Describe the Portuguese, Dutch and French in India with key events. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks